

Researchers find stealthy Linux Trojan that has been affecting systems for years!

Researchers have found a new Trojan for Linux systems that attackers were using to steal sensitive data from government and pharmaceutical companies. This Trojan is supposedly the missing piece of the ATP (Advance Persistent Threat) called Turla. Security researchers from Kaspersky and Symantec had discovered this ATP in August 2014.

The Trojan was unknown for years. The attackers who have created it are still unknown. Experts believe that they are backed by a nation or state. The rootkit that this malware uses makes it really hard to detect.

According to Kurt Baumgartner, security expert at Kaspersky, Turla has spread much further than what was early believed. Attackers can send hidden packets that contain numbers in special sequence. The Trojan has the ability to run arbitrary commands without the user's authentication. Experts confirm that this Trojan cannot be detected in usual ways, such as running 'netstat' commands. The malware could remain on systems for years and yet stay undetected. Kaspersky researchers have not disclosed who they believe could be involved in developing this Trojan.

Researchers advise users on how to check for Turla infected systems—by checking if your outgoing traffic is directed to `news-bbc.podzone[.]org` or `80.248.65.183`. These addresses give control and command line access to attackers. Server admins can build a custom signature called YARA that searches for the scripts 'Remote CS is empty' and the 'TREX_PD=%u' string. Security researchers are still searching for the hidden capabilities of this Trojan. It will not be surprising if they discover more infections and malware.

IIM Indore and IIT Gandhinagar are already running broadband distance learning programmes and are now also keen to adapt courses for the MOOC platform. IIT Patna is planning to go with the 'flipped classrooms' concept, where the students will be able to study material on MOOCs and then can attend classes anywhere across the country.

NPTEL (National Programme on Technology Enhanced Learning), which is closely associated with IIT Madras, launched its first course on programming algorithms and data structures over the MOOC platform, in 2014. It will be coming up with eight new courses in January 2015, which will include a few in the humanities stream. IIT Guwahati has planned two courses for the Swayam Bharat Platform (managed by IIT-B). The institute has also proposed a partnership with IIT-M for NPTEL's MOOCs.

Android phones targeted by virus that steals all personal information and passwords!

A new virus has been identified by the cyber security sleuths, which attacks Android devices. The virus is capable of stealing vital information from the devices and also illegally sends SMSs to those on the device's contacts list. The virus has been named Android/SmsSend.

The virus can acquire as many as four aliases to trick users and carry out its deadly activities. The Computer Emergency Response Team of India (CERT-In), in its recent advisory to Android smartphone users in the country, announced, "Android/SmsSend is a premium service abuser family malware that arrives



bundled with legitimate Android applications and infects Android-based smartphones."

Once infected, it sends text messages (typically, with a link to itself or a different threat) to a specific number (usually to numbers on the device's contacts

list) and is also capable of sending SMSs to premium rate numbers. CERT-In is the key agency set up to combat hacking and phishing apart from strengthening the cyber security defences of India's Internet domain.

The agency noted that if a device gets hit by this virus, then other basic information about the smartphone, including IMEI number, device ID, device type, etc, are also compromised. The virus may also install spyware on the device.

The agency said that the virus is so dangerous that it, "steals contacts and pictures, tracks locations, steals passwords, illegally accesses text messages, crashes a complete system, steals personal banking information when logged in, installs other spyware, and disables firewalls and anti-virus programs to defend itself."

CERT-In further noted that the malware has been created by modifying a legitimate application and thereby gets redistributed across different channels. However, it has suggested a few counter measures. It has asked users to avoid using unsecured, unknown Wi-Fi networks and also to regularly take backups of all the content on the device.